

A FIELD GUIDE

DEBUNKED

PART 1 OF 11

A Plain Language Guide
to Modern Myths Sold
as Ancient Indian Science
by LOVEPREET SINGH

A grounded look at the claims flooding our feeds. Vimanas, brahmastras, cow urine cures, ancient nuclear weapons. And how to test any one of them in 60 seconds, using six simple steps.

A Note From the Author

My name is Lovepreet Singh. I am 24 years old. I love learning new things every day. I read about business, technology, politics, psychology, philosophy, economics, and history. I am curious about how the world came to be the way it is.

One day I was thinking about religion. I noticed something. Most old cultures around the world used to worship nature. That means they treated trees, rivers, mountains, the sun, and the rain as sacred, and prayed to them directly. Then, somewhere along the way, most of these old religions died. They were replaced by big organised religions like Christianity and Islam. I wanted to know what really happened. So I started reading.

What I found was both more brutal and more interesting than the simple story I had in my head. The truth does not need any fake stories or made up conspiracies. The real history is heavy enough on its own.

This book is my attempt to lay out what actually happened. I have used historians who spent their whole lives studying these events. I have used writings from people who actually lived through that time. Every claim in this book can be checked. I want this to be the kind of argument that gets stronger the more you fact check it, not weaker.

I wrote this in simple language on purpose. Big words are often used to hide weak arguments. I do not want to hide anything. I want you to understand every line, even if you know nothing at all about history, religion, or these gods beforehand. That is why, wherever a new or unfamiliar word appears, I will explain it right there. If you disagree with me after reading this, that is fine. But at least we will both be arguing about real history, not about myths.

TWO WORDS TO LEARN BEFORE WE START Two short labels appear again and again in this book. **CE** and **BCE**. The year of Jesus's birth (the founder figure of Christianity) is used as the zero point of the count. Years **after** that point are called **CE** (so 2026 CE = today). Years **before** it are called **BCE**, meaning "Before the Common Era". BCE years run backwards in time. 500 BCE is much older than 100 BCE.

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2026

What You'll Learn

- 01. Welcome to the Mess
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Parts 2 through 11 will tackle around 79 specific claims, one chapter each, all using the 6 step method you learn here.

*"Extraordinary claims require extraordinary evidence." Carl
Sagan, Cosmos, 1980*



*This is not anti Hindu. This is not anti religion. This is a bullshit
detector. Read it with an open mind.*

Welcome to the Mess

Here is a question. Your uncle on WhatsApp forwards you a message. It says: *"Lord Hanuman calculated the exact distance from Earth to the Sun, 7,000 years ago. It is written in the Hanuman Chalisa. NASA confirmed this. Proud to be Hindu! Forward to 10 people!"*

What do you do?

- **Option A.** Forward it to 12 people. It makes you feel proud.
- **Option B.** Believe it quietly. Move on with your day.
- **Option C.** Stop. Ask a question. Find out if it is actually true.

Most people pick A or B. **This book is for people who want to learn how to pick C.** Even when the claim is wrapped in a flag, a god's name, or your grandfather's voice.

We are going to look at about 79 claims floating around social media, news channels, school textbooks, university lectures, and political speeches. They all roughly say the same thing.

"Ancient India already had what modern science discovered. The West stole it from us. The Mughals destroyed it. The British hid it. We were the greatest civilisation on Earth."

Some of these claims are silly. Some are clever. A few have a tiny seed of truth wrapped in a fat lie. We will take them one by one. Slowly. Carefully. Using small words.

What This Book Is NOT

It is not anti Hindu. Hinduism is one of the oldest, deepest, most interesting religious traditions on the planet. It has produced stunning poetry like the Gita and the Upanishads. It has produced genuine philosophy. Six schools of Vedanta, Sankhya, Yoga, Nyaya. It has produced real scientific contributions. Aryabhata's astronomy. Sushruta's surgery. The decimal number system. Panini's grammar. None of that is being mocked. Not one word of it.

It is not pro Muslim, pro Christian, pro atheist, or pro Western. Every religion has people who claim their old book "predicted everything." Christians do it (the Bible code). Muslims do it (the Quran predicted the Big Bang, embryology, the speed of light). Mormons do it. Scientologists do it. We are focusing on the Indian version because that is what is flooding *our* feeds. The same logical mistakes apply to all of them.

It is not for showing off. If you read this book to win arguments at family dinners, you will lose. Your uncle will not suddenly change his mind. Your aunt will still send the cow urine forwards. The goal is to teach *you* how to think. Not how to convert others.

It is not a textbook. I am not your teacher. There is no exam. If a chapter gets boring, skip it. Come back next week. Or don't. The book is yours.

What This Book IS

A bullshit detector. That is it. That is the whole thing. By the end you will have a 6 step mental test that you can run on any claim. Religious, scientific, political, medical, financial. Doesn't matter. The test works on all of them.

Aimed at total beginners. If you can read this sentence, you can read this book. We assume zero science background. Words like "radiation," "stem cell," "calculus," "atom," "DNA." All of them will be explained from scratch using everyday things. Kitchen utensils, cricket, traffic, Bollywood, biryani, mobile phones.

Sharp. I am not going to be polite about lies. When a man with a microphone tells 1.4 billion people that the elephant head of Lord Ganesha is "proof" that ancient Indians invented plastic surgery, that is not "an alternative perspective." That is a politician selling nonsense to people who trust him. I will call it nonsense. Loudly. With sarcasm where it fits.

Fair. Where India did genuinely contribute to science, and it did, more than most people realise, I will say so. Loudly. With pride. Where credit was actually stolen by Europeans (yes, this happens), I will say that too. The goal is the **truth**. Not a flattering story or an insulting one.

Hindu vs. Hindutva. The Most Important Page in This Book

If you read only **one** chapter of this entire 11 part series, read this one.

Picture two people. Both Indian. Both born into Hindu families. Both genuinely believe in god.

Person A lights a small oil lamp at the family shrine every morning. Visits the temple on Diwali and Janmashtami. Sometimes reads a few verses of the Bhagavad Gita before bed. Cooks vegetarian on Tuesdays. Believes in karma. Doesn't think about politics much. Doesn't claim ancient Indians had nuclear weapons. Just lives a quiet life, believes what they believe, and lets others believe what they want.

Person B has a social media account with three cow emojis and a saffron flag in the bio. Calls anyone who disagrees with him "anti national." Believes the Taj Mahal was secretly a Shiva temple. Says Aryans never came to India, Indians were always here. Drank cow urine during COVID to "boost immunity." Believes Stephen Hawking privately admitted the Vedas are scientifically superior to Einstein. Forwards 14 WhatsApp messages a day.

Person A is Hindu.
Person B is Hindutva.

These are not the same thing. They are not even close.

Define the Two Words, Slowly

Hinduism is a **religion**. It is more than 4,000 years old. It is gigantic, contradictory, philosophical, ritualistic, simple, complex. All at the same time. It contains:

- High philosophy (Adi Shankara's Advaita Vedanta) and village goddess worship in the same family.
- Vegetarian Brahmins and meat eating Shakta tantrics.
- Strict monotheists who believe only Vishnu is real and wild polytheists who worship the "33 koti devatas" of the Vedas. (Quick note. In old Sanskrit "koti" meant "type" or "category", so this originally meant 33 kinds of gods. In modern Hindi "koti" means "crore", which is 10 million, so the same phrase now gets misread as 330 million gods. Both readings are floating around. Even the head count of the gods is contested.)
- Even an **atheist school** called Charvaka, which mocked the Vedas as nonsense written by clever priests to make money. Yes. An atheist school inside Hinduism. 2,600 years old.

There is **no single pope**, no central church, no single book everyone agrees on, no membership form, no baptism ceremony. Hinduism is enormous, ancient, and messy in the most beautiful possible way.

Hindutva is a **political ideology**. It is about **100 years old**. It was invented in the **1920s** by a man named **Vinayak Damodar Savarkar**, in a book called *Essentials of Hindutva* (1923).

Savarkar, and this is the funny part, was an **atheist**. He did not believe in god. He did not perform rituals. He did not care about karma or moksha or any of it. His goal was political. He wanted to define **India as a Hindu nation** in opposition to Muslims, Christians, and the British. He used Hindu symbols and Hindu pride as tools to build a political movement.

So: Hindutva uses Hinduism the way a politician uses a national flag. As a rallying device.

Why This Difference Matters For This Book

Hindutva needs Hinduism to *look* powerful, ancient, and scientifically superior to the West. Why? Because if you believe ancient India was the most advanced civilisation in history, and that "they" (Muslims, British, Christians, foreigners) ruined it, then you will vote for the people who promise to "restore" that glory.

So Hindutva politicians, gurus, and influencers **inflate** ancient achievements, **invent** fake science, and **rewrite** history.

Hinduism itself does not need any of that.

- Lord Krishna does not need a guided missile patent to be Krishna.
- Lord Shiva does not need a plastic surgery degree to be Shiva.
- The Vedas do not need to predict Einstein's equation to be worth reading.
- The Gita's philosophy is powerful on its own merits. It does not need to be the source of Christianity or quantum physics.

A devout, practising Hindu can read this entire book and lose absolutely nothing of their faith.

A Hindutva activist will hate this book, because it takes away the political weapons disguised as religious pride.

Keep that difference in your head the whole way through. When I mock the claim "Ganesha proves ancient plastic surgery," I am mocking **a politician's 2014 speech**. I am *not* mocking the god Ganesha. I am *not* mocking your grandmother's morning prayer. The target is the lie. Not the lamp.

Who Are "Bhakts," Then?

The word **bhakt** (भक्त) originally means **devotee**. It is a beautiful Sanskrit word from the **bhakti** tradition. The path of loving devotion to god. The whole Bhakti movement (12th to 17th century) produced some of India's greatest poets. Tulsidas, Meera Bai, Kabir, Surdas, Tukaram. These were genuine devotees.

In modern internet slang, "bhakt" got **hijacked**. It now means a blind political follower who defends every statement made by their political heroes, no matter how absurd, factually wrong, or self contradictory.

When this book uses "bhakt," it means **the second meaning**. The online warrior. Not the devotee. Not the grandmother. Not your average Hindu voter.

If that is not you, this book is not attacking you. If that **is** you, congratulations on opening this book anyway. That is already step one. You might learn something. Stay.

Meet the Bhakt. A Field Guide

Before we start debunking individual claims, you need to know **where the claims come from** and **who pushes them**. Because if you do not understand the messenger, you cannot fully understand the message.

Bhakts (in the political sense) come in a few standard flavours. You have met all of these. You may even be one of them on a bad day. No judgment. Just observe.

Type 1. The WhatsApp Uncle

Age: 45 to 75. Location: family group chat, always. Trademark moves: "Forward to 10 people for good luck." Images of Modi superimposed on Krishna. Screenshots of a "BBC documentary" that does not exist. Statements that begin with "*NASA scientist Dr. Subramanian confirmed...*" (no such scientist exists). Believes everything that flatters India. Suspicious of everything that does not. Sincerity level: 100%. He genuinely loves his country. He just does not know how to verify things. Be kind. He grew up in a world without Google.

Type 2. The TV Anchor

Volume: maximum, always. Trademark moves: "Are you suggesting that Lord Ram is a MYTH?!" Cuts the mic of any guest who disagrees. Says "the people of India want to know" instead of asking actual questions. Salary: very high. Believes whatever pays well this quarter.

Type 3. The Godman or Guru

Outfit: saffron robes, very expensive watch. Trademark moves: claims to have stopped ageing. Sells cow urine soap for ₹5,000 a bottle. Has a private jet. Tells women not to wear jeans. Has a TV channel. Sometimes ends up in jail. Believes that you believe him.

Type 4. The Politician on a Stage

Audience: 50,000 people. Trademark moves: "*When Hanuman flew across the ocean, he was using technology that NASA still cannot understand.*" Crowd cheers. Crowd does not Google. Notable example: "*There must have been some plastic surgeon at that time who got an elephant's head on the body of a human being and began the practice of plastic surgery.*" Actual quote. October 2014, at a hospital opening in Mumbai. Said by Narendra Modi, the Prime Minister of India.

Type 5. The Online Warrior

Username: something like `ProudHindu_Bharat_1947` with 73 followers. Trademark moves: reply spamming any tweet that criticises anything Indian with "ANTI NATIONAL," "GO TO PAKISTAN," or "URBAN NAXAL." Has read: Twitter threads. Sometimes WhatsApp. Has not read: the Vedas, the Gita, any history book published after 1995, or any scientific paper ever.

Type 6. The University Vice Chancellor

This one is the saddest, because they have a PhD and should know better. Notable example: **G. Nageshwar Rao**, Vice Chancellor of Andhra University. At the **2019 Indian Science Congress** (a real, official scientific conference), he stood on stage in front of cameras and said:

- The 100 Kauravas from the Mahabharata are proof that ancient Indians invented stem cell research and test tube babies.
- Ravana had 24 types of aircraft and multiple airports in Sri Lanka.
- Lord Vishnu's Sudarshan Chakra (his spinning weapon) was a guided missile with target tracking that boomerangs back.

This was at a science conference. With real scientists in the audience. Who had to sit there politely while their entire profession was being humiliated.

Why Do They All Push These Claims?

Four motivations, in order of how common they are.

1. **Money.** Cow urine companies, ayurvedic "scientific" products, godmen with TV channels, gurus selling miracle yoga. All of them profit from selling pseudoscience.
2. **Power.** Politicians get votes by making people feel that their religion is superior and is under attack.
3. **Sincere belief.** Some pushers genuinely believe what they are saying. They grew up with these stories. Nobody ever taught them how to test a claim.
4. **Insecurity.** A small voice inside says, "*What if our civilisation wasn't actually the greatest?*" The bigger the claim, the louder it drowns out the small voice.

Knowing the motive does not tell you the claim is true or false. **The claim has to be tested on its own.** But knowing the motive helps you understand why a claim will not die even after it has been debunked 100 times.

The 6 Step Debunk. Your X Ray Vision

This is the tool. The whole book runs on this. Every single one of the 79 or so claims in the next 10 parts will be run through these 6 steps. Once you learn the pattern, you can run it yourself on any claim, without me.

Here are the 6 steps. Memorise them or bookmark this page.

Step 1. What is the claim, exactly?

Write it down in **one sentence**. If you cannot, the claim is too vague to test. Vagueness is a red flag.

Example: *"Ancient India had flying machines called Vimanas, described in the Vaimanika Shastra, which could fly between planets."* Good. One sentence. Specific. Now we can test it.

Bad version: *"Ancient Indians knew everything modern science knows."* This is useless. Knew what? About what? Discovered by whom? Test what?

WHY THIS STEP MATTERS. Vague claims can never be wrong, because they never said anything specific. This is a common trick. Force the claim to commit.

Step 2. Where did the claim come from?

Trace it backwards. Who said it first? When? In what context?

- Is the source a 3,000 year old text? Show me the verse.
- Is it a politician? When and where did they say it?
- Is it "ancient knowledge"? Find me the page number.
- Is it a "NASA scientist"? Show me their actual name and their actual paper.

95% of these claims fall apart at Step 2. They have no source. Or the source is a 1952 self published book by a guy with no scientific training. Or the source is "a guru told me."

Step 3. What does the ORIGINAL text actually say?

This is the killer step. When someone says *"It is written in the Vedas that the speed of light is 186,000 miles per second,"* open the Vedas. Find the verse. Read it. In Sanskrit and English, side by side.

You will be **shocked** by how often the original verse says nothing remotely like what the claim claims.

It is like the game of Telephone you played in school. One person whispers "I like apples" and by the time it goes around the room it becomes "Igor flies airplanes." The Vedic verse usually says something poetic and beautiful, and the claim has twisted it into a science textbook entry.

WHY THIS STEP MATTERS. Most bhakts have never read the actual scripture they are quoting. They have only read other people's claims about the scripture. You will know more than them after 5 minutes of Googling.

Step 4. What does the actual science say?

Now we look at the modern scientific concept the claim is being mapped to. If the claim is "Brahmastra = nuclear weapon," we need to know what a nuclear weapon actually is. Not from a movie. From physics. If the claim is "Karna was a test tube baby," we need to know what IVF actually involves. The steps. The equipment. The biology.

You do not need a PhD. You need a basic, honest understanding of the modern thing. We will cover the science in plain English every single time, with analogies.

Step 5. Compare. Does the ancient description actually match the modern science?

This is where the magic happens. Almost every time, you find:

- The ancient text describes a god like power. ("A weapon brighter than a thousand suns.")
- The modern science requires specific, unique conditions. (Uranium 235, critical mass, fission, gamma radiation, etc.)
- The two do not match at all. The ancient description matches *many* things. A comet, a meteor, a forest fire, a poetic exaggeration, a hallucination, a vivid dream.

This is called **the specificity test**. A real prediction has to be specific enough that it could only mean one thing. "It was bright and powerful" could describe anything from a nuclear bomb to a cricket stadium light. "It was a U 235 implosion device with a tamper of natural uranium and a neutron initiator at the centre" would be a real prediction. The ancient texts never give that level of detail. Never. Because they were not science textbooks. They were epics and prayers and poems.

Step 6. Be fair. What did India ACTUALLY contribute in this area?

This is the part bhakts skip and Western critics also skip. It is the most important step for honesty. Almost every "fake claim" has a **real Indian contribution** hiding nearby that is actually genuinely impressive.

- The "Vimana = airplane" claim is fake. **But** ancient Indian astronomy was genuinely world class. Aryabhata calculated π to four decimal places in 499 CE.
- The "Ganesha = plastic surgery" claim is silly. **But** Sushruta (traditionally dated around 600 BCE) wrote the world's first detailed surgical manual, including real nose reconstruction techniques. The Indian method was published in Britain's *Gentleman's Magazine* in 1794, and the British surgeon Joseph Carpue used it to perform the first European nose reconstruction in 1814. So Europeans really did copy it. Just slightly later than the 1700s.
- The "Karna = test tube baby" claim is absurd. **But** ancient Indian medicine (Ayurveda) was the first systematic medical tradition in human history.
- The "Zero was invented here" claim is mostly true. Indians did invent the decimal place value system with zero. That alone is one of the most important inventions in human history.

So the real honest story is this. **India was great in many real ways. It does not need fake credit for nuclear bombs.** Loving your country means telling the truth about it, not inflating it.

That is the test. Six steps. Run any claim through it. By Part 11, you will do this in your head in about 30 seconds without needing the list.

Ten Logical Tricks the Claim Makers Use

Before we start debunking actual claims, you need to know the **tricks**. These are mental shortcuts that fool your brain. Once you can name them, they stop working on you.

Here are the 10 most common tricks in the Hindutva pseudoscience playbook. They also appear in pseudoscience from every other culture. We are just naming the Indian flavour.

01 The Vague Match

Take a vague poetic line from a scripture. Match it loosely to a modern invention. Declare victory. Example. Scripture says: *"Sanjay could see the war from far away through divine vision."* Modern invention: Television. Claim: *"Mahabharata predicted TV!"*

The trick: "seeing from far away" describes literally anything that lets you see far. A telescope, binoculars, a satellite, a drone, a window on a tall building, a dream, a vision, magic. Saying it is specifically "television" is choosing one of a hundred possible meanings.

Counter: Ask, *"Why TV and not radio, or satellite, or a telescope, or simply magic?"* The original text gives no specific detail that picks out TV.

02 Reading Backwards (Hindsight Mapping)

Modern thing exists. Someone goes hunting through ancient texts. They find something vaguely similar. They say the ancient text "predicted" it. This is called **retrofitting**. It is the same trick Nostradamus believers use. After every disaster, they "find" a verse that "predicted" it. They never find the verse *before* the disaster. Strange, that.

03 The Cherry Pick

Take one nice line from a scripture. Ignore the other 10,000 lines that say weird, wrong, or contradictory things. Example: a scripture says the Earth is round in one verse. The same scripture says the Earth rests on the back of a giant turtle, which rests on elephants, which rest on a giant snake. The bhakt quotes the first line as "proof of ancient knowledge." Ignores the turtle.

04 The Translation Sleight of Hand

Sanskrit is a rich, ambiguous, poetic language. Many words have 5 to 10 possible meanings. Bhakts pick the **modern sounding** translation, then claim the original meant exactly that. Example: the word *"vimana"* in Sanskrit can mean a flying chariot of the gods, a temple tower, a measurement, a palace, or a type of literary meter. Bhakts always translate it as "airplane." Always. Never as "temple tower," even when the text clearly means a building.

05 The Fake Authority

"NASA scientist Dr. Subbarao confirmed that Sanskrit is the best language for AI." You will hear this 100 times. **No such NASA scientist exists.** The original "source" is a 1985 article by Rick Briggs, who was an AI researcher at NASA Ames briefly, who wrote one paper saying Sanskrit's grammar is interesting for natural language processing. That is it. He never said it was "the best." He never said NASA used it.

06 The Stolen Credit Story

"Europeans stole this from us!" Sometimes true. Often false. Always emotional. **True example:** the decimal number system did go from India to the Arabs to Europe. Real theft of credit. **False example:** "The Wright Brothers stole Talpade's airplane design." Zero documentary evidence. The two events are unconnected.

07 The Argument from Antiquity

"It is ancient, so it must be true." Astrology is ancient. So is bloodletting. So is the belief that menstrual blood makes you spiritually dirty. So is sacrificing animals to make rain. **Age does not equal truth.**

08The Pride Hijack

The emotional trick. When you challenge a claim, the bhakt says: *"You are insulting your own culture. You are a slave of the West. You don't love your country."* Notice what happened. Instead of defending the claim, they attacked you. This is called **ad hominem**. Attacking the person, not the argument. **Counter:** "I love my country, which is why I want it associated with the truth, not with embarrassing lies."

09The "If You Cannot Disprove It, It Is True"

"Can you prove ancient Indians DIDN'T have nuclear weapons?" This flips the burden of proof. In honest debate, the person making the claim has to provide evidence. You do not have to prove it is wrong. They have to prove it is right. This is called **Russell's Teapot**. The philosopher Bertrand Russell pointed out: *"If I claim there is a tiny teapot orbiting the Sun between Earth and Mars, too small for any telescope to detect, you cannot prove me wrong. But that does not make me right."*

10The "Even If 1% Is True"

"Out of 100 claims, even if only 1 is true, that is still impressive!" No, it is not. If 99 of your claims are nonsense, your credibility is gone. The 1 true thing might also be coincidence. Quality beats quantity.

How to Read a Sanskrit Verse Without Getting Fooled

You do not need to learn Sanskrit. But you do need to know **how it works**, because Sanskrit's structure is the single biggest tool of fakery in this whole game.

1. Sanskrit Words Have MANY Meanings

In English, "bank" means a river bank or a money bank. Two meanings. That is the norm. In Sanskrit, a single word can have 6, 8, sometimes 15 or more meanings. Words are layered. They depend on context. They depend on which philosophical school is interpreting them.

Examples:

- **Loka.** World, region, universe, people, earth, heaven, or one of many "planes of existence."
- **Akasha.** Sky, space, void, a fundamental "ether" element, the inner space of consciousness, the medium of sound.
- **Atman.** Soul, self, breath, essence, the universal consciousness.
- **Vimana.** Flying chariot, temple, palace, measurement, poetic meter.

Bhakts always pick the meaning that sounds most modern. **Always check the context.** If the verse is about a temple, "vimana" almost certainly means temple tower. Not airplane.

2. Sanskrit Texts Are Poems, Not Manuals

The Vedas, Puranas, Mahabharata, Ramayana. These are **literature**. They are religious poetry, philosophical dialogue, mythological narrative. They are NOT science textbooks. They were never trying to be.

Reading the Mahabharata as a physics paper is like reading a love song as a chemistry paper. You can find anything you want if you twist hard enough. But that is your imagination, not the song's intent.

3. The Same Verse Has Been Interpreted Differently for 2,000 Years

Hindu scholars themselves have argued about what the verses mean for two thousand years. Different schools (Advaita, Vishishtadvaita, Dvaita, Mimamsa, and others) interpret the same line in completely different ways. There is no single "correct" interpretation.

So when a politician says "*The Vedas clearly say...*" that is a giveaway. The Vedas do not "clearly say" anything. They have been argued about for millennia.

4. Translation Matters Enormously

Get the verse in three sources:

1. The original Sanskrit (just the sound).
2. A literal word by word translation.
3. A meaning based translation by a respected scholar. Max Müller, Sri Aurobindo, R.C. Zaehner, Wendy Doniger.

If your bhakt source disagrees with all three of those, the bhakt source is probably making things up.

A 5 Minute Crash Course on What Science Actually Is

Before we debunk science claims, you need to know **what science is**, briefly. Science is not a list of facts. Science is a **method**. The method has 5 steps.

Step 1. Observation

You notice something. *"Apples fall down. They never fall up."*

Step 2. Hypothesis

You propose an explanation. *"Maybe the Earth pulls things toward itself."*

Step 3. Prediction

You make a specific, testable prediction. *"If the Earth pulls things, then an iron ball and a feather should fall at the same speed in a vacuum."*

Step 4. Test

You do the experiment. Astronauts on the Moon dropped a hammer and a feather. They hit the ground at the same time. The prediction was correct.

Step 5. Repeat, Refine, Reject

Anyone in the world can repeat the test. If it works every time, the hypothesis becomes a **theory**. A tested, predictive model. If it fails, you reject it and try again. That is it. That is science.

IMPORTANT WORD: "THEORY" In everyday English, "theory" means "guess." ("I have a theory my keys are in the car.") In science, "theory" means the **opposite**. A tested, evidence backed framework that has survived many attempts to prove it wrong. The Theory of Gravity. The Theory of Evolution. The Theory of Relativity. These are not guesses. They are the strongest forms of knowledge science can produce. When a bhakt says "evolution is just a theory," they are using the wrong meaning of the word.

Why Ancient Texts Are Not Science

The Vedas, the Mahabharata, the Quran, the Bible. None of them follow the 5 step method. They give you statements. They do not test the statements. They do not refine the statements when new evidence comes in. They do not accept being proven wrong.

That does not make them worthless. They are valuable as **philosophy, poetry, ethics, history, culture, and personal meaning**. But they are not science. They never claimed to be science. The bhakt claim that they *are* science is a modern invention. About a century old, growing rapidly since the 1990s.

Why "Eastern Wisdom" Claims Are Sneaky

A common move is to say: *"Science is just a Western thing. Eastern wisdom is older and deeper."* Sounds nice. Wrong.

Science is **not Western**. Science is a method, not a place. Indians, Chinese, Arabs, Greeks, Africans. Every civilisation has practised bits of it. Aryabhata using observation to calculate the Earth's circumference. That is science. Ibn al Haytham doing controlled optical experiments in 11th century Cairo (yes, Cairo, not Baghdad. He was born in Basra but did his main work under the Fatimid caliphate in Egypt). That is science. Sushruta dissecting cadavers to learn anatomy. That is science. The 5 step method has no flag. It belongs to humanity.

Pretending science is a foreign thing is a **defensive move**. It lets you reject inconvenient findings as "Western bias." It does not matter who built the telescope. The stars look the same through it.

How to Use This Book

You are almost at the end of Part 1. Here is how to read the next 10 parts.

The Structure of Each Claim Chapter

Every claim in Parts 2 to 10 follows the same template. Once you know the template, you can predict what is coming. That is a feature, not a bug. Repetition is how learning sticks.

Each chapter has these 6 sections, in this order:

1. **The Claim.** One sentence. Exactly what is being said on WhatsApp.
2. **Where It Came From.** Who started this, when, why.
3. **What the Original Text Actually Says.** The verse, translated honestly.
4. **The Real Science.** Modern concept explained for total beginners, with simple analogies.
5. **The Debunk.** Where the claim breaks. Point by point.
6. **The Honest Picture.** What India ACTUALLY contributed in this area.

After every chapter, you will find 2 or 3 short questions ("Test Yourself") to make sure the points stuck. Do not skip them. They take 30 seconds.

Reading Order

- You can read the parts in any order. Each part stands alone.
- If you are impatient, jump to Part 2 (Vimanas and flying machines). Most popular claim.
- If you want the most jaw dropping debunk, try Part 4 (medical claims, cow urine, Ganesha plastic surgery).
- If you want the deepest history lesson, try Part 7 (Aryan migration, Taj Mahal, and others).

Don't Believe Me

This book has citations at the end of every part. Read them. Check them. Disagree with them. If you find I am wrong about something, write it down and we will fix it. The goal is not for you to swap "trust your uncle" for "trust this book." The goal is for you to **trust the verification process**. Step 1 through Step 6. And apply it to everything, including me.

A Glossary Preview

These words will come up again and again. We will explain each one properly when it first appears in a chapter, but here is a quick preview so they are not scary.

Word	Plain meaning
Atom	The smallest piece of a chemical element. Imagine cutting a piece of iron in half forever. Eventually you get to a single iron "ball" that cannot be split further by chemistry. That is an atom.
Radiation	Energy flying through space or matter. Light is radiation. Microwaves are radiation. The dangerous stuff from a nuclear bomb is radiation.
Nuclear fission	Splitting the centre of an atom (its nucleus) to release a huge burst of energy. This is what nuclear bombs and nuclear power plants do.
IVF	"In vitro" = "in glass." A doctor takes an egg from a woman, sperm from a man, mixes them in a glass dish in a lab, lets them form an embryo, then places the embryo back in a womb. First successful IVF baby: 1978.
Stem cell	A "blank slate" cell that has not decided yet what it will grow into. It can become a brain cell, a heart cell, a skin cell, and so on.
DNA	The "instruction book" inside every cell that tells the cell how to build a body. Like a 3 billion letter recipe for "how to make this human." Structure discovered in 1953.
Genetic engineering	Editing the recipe. Modern science only started doing this seriously in the 1970s.
Calculus	A branch of math for handling changing things. Speeds that change, areas under curves, and so on. Invented (or co invented) by Newton and Leibniz in the 1600s. The Kerala school of mathematicians (14th to 16th century India) developed key pre cursors.
Photosynthesis	The chemical process by which plants use sunlight to make food. Side effect: they release oxygen. Important for the "Tulsi releases oxygen 24 hours" claim. They do not, actually.
Heliocentrism	"Helio" = sun. The idea that the Sun is the centre, and planets go around it. Opposite: geocentrism. Earth at the centre.

We will properly unpack each of these as they show up.

What You Just Learned and Sources

What You Just Learned

- The difference between **Hinduism** (4,000 year old religion) and **Hindutva** (100 year old political ideology).
- The 6 main types of claim pushers ("bhakts" in the political sense).
- The **6 step debunk method**. The tool you will use on every claim.
- The **10 tricks** claim makers use, and how to spot them.
- A 5 minute version of what **science** actually is and how it differs from scripture.
- A preview of the **vocabulary** you will need (atom, radiation, IVF, stem cell, and others).

What's Next

Part 2. Flying Machines and Ancient Tech. We will start with the big one. Vimanas. The Vaimanika Shastra. Shivkar Talpade's "1895 airplane." Pushpak Vimana. The Mahabharata's "internet." TV in the form of Sanjay's "Divya Drishti." It is going to be brutal. The Vimana claim is one of the most quoted and one of the most easily destroyed.

Sources for Part 1

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Russell, Bertrand. "Is There a God?" 1952. Russell's Teapot. The burden of proof argument.

Sagan, Carl. *The Demon Haunted World: Science as a Candle in the Dark*. 1995. The classic guide to bullshit detection. Highly recommended companion reading.

Indian Journal of History of Science. Multiple peer reviewed articles on actual ancient Indian science (Aryabhata, Sushruta, Panini, the Kerala school).

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The strongest argument is the one that can survive a fact check.

Make sure yours always can.

LOVEPREET SINGH